AVÈRO ADVISORS

TEMPLATE 05

START AT ZERO TOOLKIT · TEMPLATE 05

Go/No-Go Decision Criteria

Objective, evidence-based criteria for the end of Phase Zero and the week before go-live, with critical items, decision rules and a conditional approval path.

"It feels ready" is how disasters get approved. At each major juncture you need criteria that were agreed before the pressure arrived, evidence attached to each one, and a rule for what happens when the evidence falls short. This template covers the two gates that matter most: the end of Phase Zero and the week before go-live.

GO meets the threshold, with evidence.

CONDITIONAL GO meets the threshold with a documented mitigation, owner and date.

NO-GO does not meet the threshold.

Decision rules

- **GO:** every critical criterion is GO and no more than two non-critical criteria are conditional.
- **CONDITIONAL GO:** any critical criterion is conditional, or three or more non-critical are. Each condition goes on the form below and the Executive Sponsor signs it.
- **NO-GO:** a single critical criterion is NO-GO. The decision halts until it is resolved and the gate is re-run.
- The independent PMO facilitates and presents the evidence. The Executive Sponsor decides. Vendors and integrators give input but do not vote.

Gate A: End of Phase Zero (proceed to procurement?)

#	Criterion	Critical	Evidence	Rating
A1	Executive Sponsor committed in writing, with protected time	CRITICAL	Signed charter, calendar	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A2	Key processes documented and validated by their owners	CRITICAL	Process inventory sign-offs	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A3	Business case with true TCO, and funding secured or a clear path	CRITICAL	Business case, budget action	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A4	Data quality assessed, cleansing plan and effort estimated	CRITICAL	Data quality scorecard	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A5	Integration inventory complete with owners		Integration inventory	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A6	Requirements prioritized and ready for an RFP	CRITICAL	Requirements outline	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A7	No unaddressed high-power opponent on the stakeholder map		Stakeholder map, engagement plan	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A8	Compliance matrix and risk register complete, with owners		Matrix, register	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A9	AI governance and readiness assessed, AI position set for the RFP		Template 03 results	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO

#	Criterion	Critical	Evidence	Rating
A10	Governance defined: steering committee, decision rights, independent oversight	CRITICAL	Governance charter, Template 02	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A11	Staffing and backfill plan approved		HR approval	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
A12	Independence confirmed: advisors and evaluators free of vendor ties	CRITICAL	Signed attestations	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO

Gate B: Pre-go-live (switch on the new system?)

#	Criterion	Critical	Evidence	Rating
TECHNICAL READINESS				
B1	No open critical or high severity defects	CRITICAL	Defect log	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B2	Performance and load testing passed	CRITICAL	Test report	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B3	Integrations tested end to end	CRITICAL	Integration test results	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B4	Data migration validated, financial balances reconcile	CRITICAL	Reconciliation sign-off	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B5	Rollback plan documented and rehearsed	CRITICAL	Rehearsal record	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B6	Security review complete and user roles approved	CRITICAL	Security sign-off	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
USER READINESS				
B7	At least 90% of users trained for their role, proficiency shown		Training records	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B8	Super users certified and scheduled for go-live support		Roster	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B9	Help desk staffed for the surge, ticket routing tested		Staffing plan	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
ORGANIZATIONAL READINESS				
B10	Leadership and department heads formally confirm readiness	CRITICAL	Signed confirmations	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B11	Change Champions active, go-live communications sent		Comms log	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
OPERATIONAL READINESS				
B12	Cutover runbook final, hour by hour, with owners	CRITICAL	Runbook	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B13	Parallel run or mock conversion within agreed thresholds	CRITICAL	Parallel run results	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B14	Vendor and integrator support confirmed through stabilization		Support plan	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO
B15	Go-live date clear of payroll, year-end and other critical cycles		Calendar check	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO

Conditional approval path

#	Condition	Mitigation	Owner	Due	Verified by PMO

Third gate, end of stabilization. Before releasing final payment holdbacks, confirm that critical defects are closed, adoption targets are met, month-end close runs on the new system, and benefits tracking has started.

Decision record

Gate	Decision	Executive Sponsor	Independent PMO	Date
Gate A	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO			
Gate B	☐ GO ☐ COND ☐ NO-GO			

When the sponsor asks "are we ready?", the answer should be a page of evidence, not a room full of opinions.

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